



ROXANNE JENSEN'S Blue Malibu souvenir shop, clockwise from top left, is open for the very first time in months, as well as Jefferson Wagner's surf shop, Zuma Jay's, and the Country Kitchen, where Joel Ruiz works.



Photographs by JASON ARMOND Los Angeles Times

Feds focus on illegal workers at pot farms

Laborer dies from fall in an operation that becomes a spectacle on the Central Coast.

By MELISSA GOMEZ, JESSICA GARRISON, PAIGE ST. JOHN AND JEANETTE MARANTOS

A massive show of federal law enforcement agents swept through rural corners of Ventura and Santa Barbara counties this week in the largest of the Trump administration's weeks-long campaign against undocumented immigrants in California — and the deadliest.

Farmworker advocates said Friday afternoon that one laborer had died from injuries sustained after falling from the roof of a greenhouse at Glass House can-

nabis operation while trying to escape federal agents — the first death as a result of an immigration sweep.

The raid by agents from Homeland Security Investigations, the California National Guard and the Drug Enforcement Administration, among others, has placed a spotlight on the well-known cannabis company, which has become central to the local economy.

The operation began when immigration agents surrounded large greenhouse facilities in Camarillo and Carpinteria on Thursday and, after presenting warrants, began entering buildings. The result was hours of chaos, particularly at the company's Camarillo outpost.

As people screamed "*La migrá! La migrá!*" workers began to run in a panic, hid- [See Cannabis, A9]



JULIE LEOPOLFO For The Times

PROTESTERS confront federal agents during an immigration raid on Thursday in Camarillo.

Head Start will be stopped for some

People without legal status will be barred from federal program, Kennedy announces.

By JENNY GOLD

Health and Human Services Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. announced Thursday that undocumented immigrants will no longer be allowed to attend Head Start, the federal program that provides child care, nutrition and health assistance to 800,000 low-income infants, toddlers and preschoolers.

The announcement immediately bars all people living in the country without legal status from a suite of federally funded public programs, including health

clinics, family planning and the low-income energy assistance program.

While those living in the country illegally are prohibited from using most federal programs, a 1998 notice allowed them to access certain benefits relied on by low-income families with young children. In a news release, however, Kennedy announced that Health and Human Services was rescinding this interpretation, limiting the ability of low-income immigrant families to use more than a dozen federal programs run by the agency.

"For too long, the government has diverted hard-working Americans' tax dollars to incentivize illegal immigration," Kennedy said. "Today's action changes that — it restores integrity to [See Head Start, A9]

Not peak season for all

Malibu businesses that survived the January fires are adapting to a changed landscape during the usually busy summertime

By Caroline Petrow-Cohen

Six months after the Palisades fire roared down Pacific Coast Highway, the Country Kitchen in Malibu is open for business, but many customers have yet to return.

The no-frills eatery features a few outdoor tables and ocean views, nestled in a narrow parking lot alongside a liquor store and gift shop. The restaurant, which opened in 1972, is literally a hole in the wall. It serves breakfast burritos all day and burgers out of a window.

It wasn't destroyed by the fires but had extensive smoke damage. It was cut off

from most of its customers for close to five months, waiting for the highway to reopen. Business is a lot better than it was a couple of months ago, but still well below what the restaurant would usually see this time of year.

"Things are better, but if you compare it to last year, it's still probably 25% less business," said Joel Ruiz, who has worked at the Country Kitchen for 40 years.

Up and down the coast, businesses that survived the flames are still hoping for a return to normalcy. As cus-

tomers slowly return to a changed landscape, the small businesses that dot Pacific Coast Highway wonder how long it will take to get back to business as usual.

PCH was closed to nonresidents for five months following the Palisades fire, isolating the once-bustling businesses that catered to beachgoers and tourists.

According to the California Department of Forestry and Fire Protection, the Palisades fire charred more than 23,000 acres and destroyed more than 6,000

structures. The blaze burned the vast majority of homes along the ocean from Topanga Canyon to Las Flores Canyon.

Nearly 800 structures were lost in Malibu, including the Reel Inn, a seafood restaurant just a few miles down the road from the Country Kitchen. Other popular restaurants including Duke's Malibu are still closed due to damage. Caffe Luxxe near Carbon Beach was closed for months before reopening in May.

It should be peak summer season for Zuma Jay's, [See Malibu, A1]

Heat waves get longer, stronger

Frequency will also increase around the globe, UCLA scientists say

By CLARA HARTER

As sizzling temperatures sweep across Southern California this week, UCLA researchers have released a new finding that the duration of heat waves is increasing faster than global warming.

Researchers found that heat waves are not only get-

ting hotter, but also becoming longer at a rate that will accelerate as the planet continues to warm.

"Each fraction of a degree of warming will have more impact than the last," said UCLA climate scientist David Neelin, who helped lead the study.

This means that even relatively modest warming can significantly boost the

risk of powerful, enduring heat waves — underscoring the need to develop strategies to help keep people, agriculture and infrastructure safe in extreme heat, he said.

"If the rate of warming stays the same, the rate of our adaptation has to happen quicker and quicker, especially for the most extreme heat waves, which are changing the fastest," Neelin

said in a statement.

In Southern California, longer heat waves will dry out vegetation and increase the danger of wildfires, Neelin said in an interview. Worsening heat waves also pose a serious threat to farming because many crops will die at sustained high temperatures, he added.

[See Heat, A14]

Trump tours flash-flood damage in Texas

Since the deadly disaster, he has been silent on past pledges to shut down FEMA.

By SEAN MURPHY AND WILL WEISSERT

KERRVILLE, Texas — President Trump on Friday toured the devastation from catastrophic flooding in Texas and lauded local officials amid mounting criticism that they failed to warn residents fast enough that a deadly wall of water was coming their way.

"The search for the missing continues. The people that are doing it are unbelievable," Trump told first responders and other state and local officials gathered at an emergency operations center in an expo hall in Kerrville.

"You couldn't get better



CHIP SOMODEVILLA Getty Images

PRESIDENT TRUMP, left, and an emergency services representative next to debris in Kerrville, Texas.

people, and they're doing the job like I don't think anybody else could, frankly," Trump said.

The president said his administration "is doing everything it can to help Texas" and insisted that "we've got some good people" running the Federal Emergency Management Agency.

Since the Fourth of July disaster, which has killed at least 120 people and left more than 170 missing, the president has been conspicuously silent on his past repeated promises to do away with FEMA. Instead, he's focused on the once-in-a-lifetime nature of what occurred and the human tragedy. He has praised Texas and local officials while emphasizing the administration's government-slashing crusade that's been popular with Trump's core supporters.

[See Disaster, A7]

Octogenarian aces this test of toughness

By JAMES RAINEY

California does not lack for extreme sports settings. Surfers have the mountainous waves of Mavericks Beach near Half Moon Bay. Climbers have the awesome granite monoliths of Yosemite Valley. And ultra runners have Badwater. That's shorthand for the Badwater Basin in Death Valley, the starting place of an annual summer competition that bills itself as "the world's toughest foot race."

This week, the Badwater 135 Ultramarathon lived up to its billing, for the 48th year, challenging humans to run from the lowest point in North America to the shoulders of the highest peak in the continental U.S. The 135-mile run takes competitors from around the world from the baking floor of Death Valley, where temperatures hit 117 degrees, to the thin-

ning air of Whitney Portal, at more than 8,300 feet, the trailhead to glorious Mt. Whitney. Ninety-three people completed the ordeal within the allotted 48-hour time window this week, headlined by the oldest competitor ever to finish the course, 80-year-old Bob Becker of Fort Lauderdale, Fla. "It was pretty emotional to finish," Becker said by phone from Lone Pine on Thursday, the morning after finishing, a little more than 45 hours after he started. "I was just so happy to be there and to have so many people cheering me on."

It took Becker a little more than double the time of this year's winner, Simen Holvik of Norway, who finished in 21 hours and a little less than 48 minutes. That's about 15 minutes slower than the record holder, Yoshihiko Ishikawa of Japan, who set the mark in [See Badwater, A14]

Aid for people affected by raids

Mayor Bass says cash cards will be available for immigrants and that funds won't come from the city. CALIFORNIA, B1

Bill could help Dodgers gondola

Legislation would limit environmental blocks to transportation projects such as Chavez Ravine proposal. SPORTS, B12

DC seeks revival with 'Superman'

Film sets out to reboot a franchise hobbled by box office misfires, mixed creative vision and Marvel rivalry. BUSINESS, A10

Weather Turning sunny. L.A. Basin: 82/62. B8

